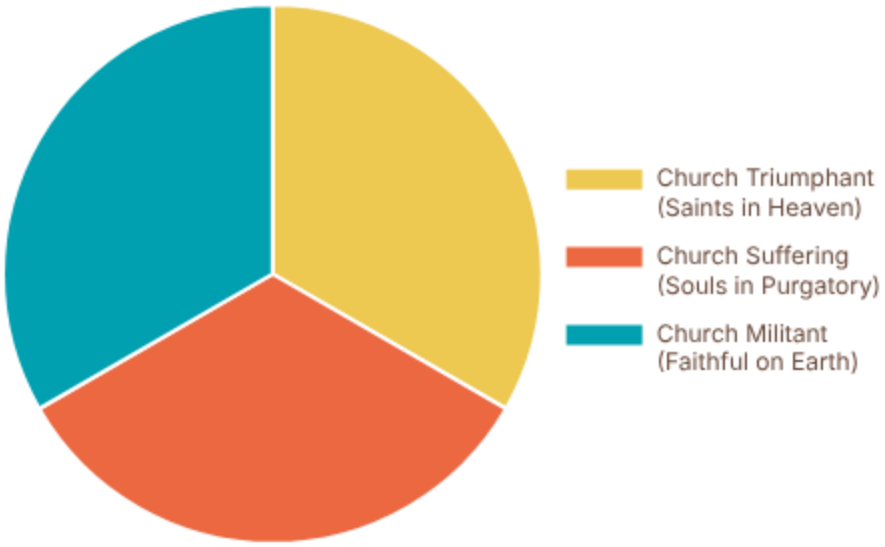
The Church: Our Eternal Family

A visual guide to the identity and mission of the Church based on USCCA Chapters 10 & 11.

The Communion of Saints: An Eternal Family

On All Souls' Day (Nov 2nd), we are reminded that the Church is an eternal community that spans three states. We are all connected, praying for and supporting one another.



This chart illustrates the three states of the one Church: all members united in Christ, whether on Earth, in purification, or in glory.

Part 1: The Nature of the Church (Chapter 10)

Chapter 10 asks, "What is the Church?" It is a profound mystery explained through three key images showing its relationship with God.

👥

1. The People of God (Called)

We are a community called out by God. Every baptized person shares in Christ's three offices:

- **Priestly (To Worship)**
- **Prophetic (To Proclaim)**
- **Kingly (To Serve)**

🤝

2. The Body of Christ (United)

Christ is the Head, and we are the members. This image highlights two core truths: Unity and Diversity. Every person is essential.



We are one Body, with diverse vocations and talents, all necessary for the whole.

🔥

3. Temple of the Holy Spirit (Animated)

The Holy Spirit is the "soul of the Church," giving it life, guiding its leaders, and helping every member grow in holiness.

The Spirit:

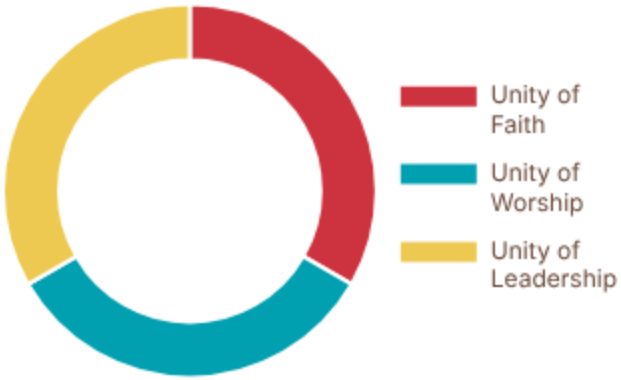
- Gives Life (Sanctifies)
- Unifies (Builds Community)
- Guides (Leads to Truth)

Part 2: The Four Marks of the Church (Chapter 11)

Chapter 11 answers, "How do we recognize the Church?" It is identified by four essential Marks we profess in the Creed.

1. The Church is ONE

The Church is one in its source (God), founder (Jesus), and spirit. This unity is visible through three key bonds:



These three bonds—shared Faith, universal Worship, and unified Leadership (Magisterium)—protect the Church's unity.

2. The Church is HOLY

Its source is Christ (100% Holy) and its purpose is to make us holy. This creates a paradox: the Church is a "hospital for sinners," a perfect institution for imperfect people.

A Paradox of Grace

100%
Holy Source (Christ)

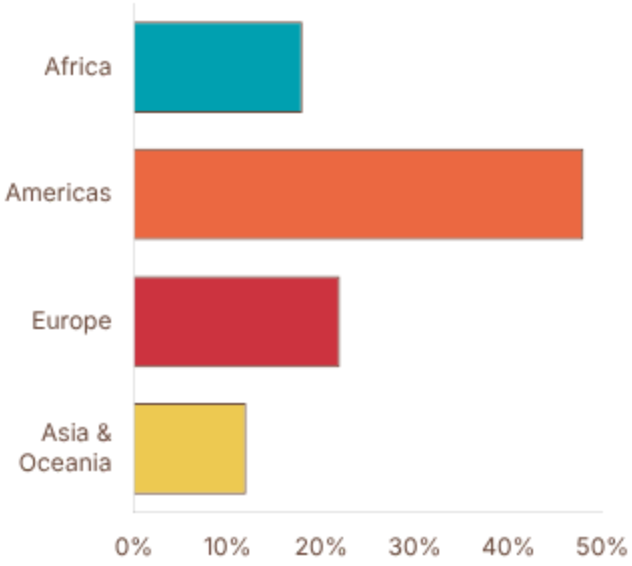
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GROW
Imperfect Members (Us)

The evidence of its holiness is the Saints—ordinary people transformed by God's grace.

3. The Church is CATHOLIC

"Catholic" means **universal**. The Church holds the fullness of truth and is sent to all people, in all times, in all places. This results in beautiful global diversity.



Hypothetical distribution of the global Catholic population, demonstrating its universal reach.

4. The Church is APOSTOLIC

The Church is built on the foundation of the Apostles. Its teachings and authority trace directly back to Jesus through Apostolic Succession.

Jesus Christ (The Founder)

⬇

The Apostles (The Foundation)

⬇

Apostolic Succession (Bishops)

⬇

Today's Church (Our Mission)

We Are All Part of This Family

From the Body of Christ to the Four Marks, the Church is revealed as a unified, holy, universal, and divinely-founded family. We are all called to participate in its mission.